Scientific Guidance and Correspondence History

David Levi-Faur's orientations, 9 September–10 October 2026

Prepared for the Law as Governance research team | 10 October 2026 | Documentary synthesis for discussion, not a formal decision register or an authorization to code.

Purpose and evidentiary boundaries

This brief reconstructs how the project's scientific priorities evolved through David's emails. It complements the R1–R7 technical progress brief: it is about scientific guidance and coordination, not a catalogue of coding outputs. Entries distinguish what David wrote from implications for the project. Messages were checked in the connected Outlook and Gmail mailboxes. Several instructions appeared in attachments; where those attachments were not individually reviewed, no claim is made about their detailed content. Administrative and payment correspondence is excluded.

Chronology of the guidance

9–10 September | Exploratory exercise and analytical population

David's communication. On 9 September David characterized the initial exercise as informative but not necessarily what he had in mind, shared an exploratory AI-assisted climate-law example, and questioned whether the law chosen suited his mechanism interests. On 10 September he stressed defining the population and reading broadly on regulatory intermediaries; he included Rotem and Michael in the discussion. [E1–E2]

Meaning for the research. An illustrative output should not become a coding or sampling rule. Corpus definition and theoretical fit precede scaling.

13 September | Five selected laws before expanding the dataset

David's communication. After the R1 report, David advised leaving wider coverage and database expansion aside and focusing on the five already selected laws. He noted that he was seeking advice on coverage. [E3]

Meaning for the research. Case-based calibration took priority over immediate population-scale construction; coverage remained open.

18–23 September | Ivana's material and green–digital comparison

David's communication. David forwarded material from work with Ivana and asked which theoretically interesting questions the dataset could answer. On 23 September he proposed analyzing three EU digital laws against the green cases to judge variable parsimony, structural compatibility, and cross-domain differences; he invited Rotem to provide the digital laws. [E4–E5]

Meaning for the research. The digital exercise was commissioned as a test of transportability and theoretical usefulness, not proof of a finalized cross-domain coding scheme.

27–29 September | Intermediaries, codebook reconciliation and conceptual coordination

David's communication. David expressed interest in a review paper on mechanisms of intermediation in green and digital transitions and mentioned possible co-authorship with Rotem. On 28 September he asked Igor to critique Rotem's proposed codebook. On 29 September he circulated a preliminary conceptual paper and welcomed Ivana to the discussion. [E6–E8]

Meaning for the research. The team's workstreams were to be brought into dialogue, without treating any preliminary codebook or authorship arrangement as final.

2 October | Conceptual paper is wider than the coding instrument

David's communication. David explained that the conceptual manuscript and the empirical codebooks should be coordinated, including lessons from Seidl and Kosti. He asked for a big-picture review of ontology, consistent implementability and the move from observations to architectural claims; coding should adopt selected relevant portions of the conceptual map, not attempt to encode the whole paper. [E9–E10]

Meaning for the research. Keep the conceptual contribution broader than the operationalized fields. Evaluate the inference bridge rather than merely multiply variables.

4 October | Controlled comparative test

David's communication. David called the approach promising, described the GDPR effort as a methodological pilot, and proposed testing two or three different laws to determine whether additional architectural procedures produce clearer or more defensible inferences than direct application of V8. He also supported sharing material with the team. In another reply he suggested using already-analyzed laws (three and three, or two and two). [E11]

Meaning for the research. This motivated comparison of two procedures using existing evidence. It did not endorse an independent competing framework.

7 October | Substantive questions and V8–RGAM relationship

David's communication. David accepted the broad complementarity of V8 and RGAM while asking how operational coding could answer questions about structural importance, governance of intermediaries, hierarchy, accountability and differences across sub-regimes. [E12]

Meaning for the research. The intellectual destination became explanation of intermediation arrangements, not indefinite methodological elaboration.

Explanatory note — RGAM. Igor proposed the Regulatory Governance Architecture Model (RGAM) as an ontological and relational specification linking legal evidence to actors, relationships, configurations and architectural inference. David considered it alongside his broader V8 relational-leximetrics framework. Their exchanges identified useful safeguards, but also overlap and excessive procedural complexity. Rather than develop RGAM as a separate framework, they provisionally set that path aside and chose to test and incorporate justified safeguards into the existing methodology. This was a decision to simplify and consolidate, not a wholesale rejection of RGAM's insights. [E11–E13]

9 October | Collective synthesis and consolidation

David's communication. In a message to Rotem, Nir, Ivana, Michael and Alexandrina, David summarized Igor's stress test across SCF, CBAM, AI Act and Directive 86/361/EEC. He identified relational precision and upward inference as risks, supported simplifying safeguards, and proposed one final larger blinded validation with reasons before considering a Version 1 freeze. He placed comparative substantive research next and solicited group input. [E13]

Meaning for the research. David's preference is integration and simplification within relational leximetrics, followed by independent review and then possible stabilization. The group had not yet approved the validation design.

10 October | Four-case methodological paper and wider consultation

David's communication. In his written feedback David favored retaining the four instruments for now, raised the possibility of a methodological paper, and requested advice from Rotem on digital cases and Ivana on green cases. His subsequent email expressly asked Igor to send the update to Nir and Michael as well, adding "Augusta." A separate message concerning the EU legal-data universe asked for broader group discussion. [E14–E16]

Meaning for the research. The consultation is a real next step; it does not designate independent reviewers, approve the proposed ~12-card sample, or authorize the separate EU data-scoping Pilot A. The reference to "Augusta" is interpreted as likely Alexandrina Augusta Bora, but remains ambiguous.

What the correspondence supports now

David's direction is to (i) integrate a small set of necessary safeguards into the existing relational-leximetrics procedure; (ii) consult colleagues on case adequacy and methodological clarity; (iii) prepare a transparently selected, independently reviewed and reasoned validation exercise; and (iv) explore a methodological paper while preserving the broader conceptual manuscript and a later substantive comparative agenda. This is a proposed sequence, not a blanket approval of coding or publication.

The four-case test yielded 56 review cards, with six initial assessments by Igor. The remaining cards have not been independently adjudicated. Neither their distribution nor the six preliminary judgments establishes comparative accuracy. The project should retain explicit caveats about common-model dependence, selective review and the limitations of original-act documentary evidence.

Decisions still open for the team

Case sufficiency and relevant contrasts; eligibility and selection of review cards; identities and prior exposure of independent reviewers; blind review, written justifications and adjudication rules; the exact set of safeguards to incorporate; scope and contribution of any methodological paper; and the point at which David and the team would consider approving Version 1. The EU data-source scoping Pilot A has a separate authorization gate.

Email evidence register

References identify date, subject and mailbox. Quotations and summaries above are from messages, not reconstructed oral conversations. Direct Outlook web links were not returned by the connector; source messages remain searchable by these exact subject/date combinations.

Ref.	Date	Subject / location
E1	9 Sep 2026	Re: Exercise [Outlook]
E2	10 Sep 2026	Re: Exercise [Outlook]
E3	13 Sep 2026	Re: R1 completed — population definition and five-case calibration corpus [Outlook]
E4	18 Sep 2026	Fwd: Material/ exercise with Ivana [Outlook]
E5	23 Sep 2026	EU digital spehres - design and preliminary analysis [Outlook]
E6	27 Sep 2026	Re: update [Outlook]
E7	28 Sep 2026	Re: Coding book update [Outlook]
E8	29 Sep 2026	Re: Coding book update [Outlook]
E9	2 Oct 2026	reconciling and learning - coordination [Outlook]
E10	2 Oct 2026	new version of our paper [Outlook]
E11	4 Oct 2026	Igor's suggestions + draft 8. new version of the paper on law and governance; reply on 4 Oct [Outlook / Gmail]
E12	7 Oct 2026	V8 and RGAM [Outlook]
E13	9 Oct 2026	Re: From coding to architecture - methodological stress test and next steps [Gmail]
E14	10 Oct 2026	Re: summary of your work so far — feedback attachment [Gmail; attachment interpretation as described in contemporary exchange]
E15	10 Oct 2026	Re: summary of your work so far — wider circulation [Gmail]
E16	10 Oct 2026	Re: Universe - A brief note on the EU legislative dataset [Gmail]